



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Latvia. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing your background — it's great that you're thinking carefully about your next steps after primary school. Since you're in Denmark, 16 years old, fluent in Danish, and have just completed *folkeskolen*, you have several solid options ahead. The best path depends on your interests, skills, and long-term goals. Here's an overview of your main options:

1. Gymnasium (STX, HHX, HTX, HF) – for academic education

If you're interested in further studies (like university), a **gymnasium** is usually the next step. There are several types:

Type	Focus	Good for people who are interested in...
STX (Alment Gymnasium)	General academic subjects (humanities, science, social studies)	University education in almost any field
HHX (Handelsskolen)	Business, economics, marketing	Business studies, economics, management
HTX (Teknisk Gymnasium)	Science, technology, engineering	Technical fields, science, IT
HF (Højere Forberedelseksamen)	Shorter, more practical	Adults or students who want a quicker path to university or specific professions

● **Recommended if** you like school, want to keep your options open, and possibly attend university later.

2. Erhvervsuddannelse (VET – vocational education and training) – for practical careers

If you're more interested in learning a **trade** or working **hands-on**, a vocational education might be right. These lead to careers like:

- Electrician, carpenter, mechanic
- Hairdresser, chef, healthcare worker
- IT technician, media production, etc.

These programs usually combine **school + apprenticeship** with real employers.

● **Recommended if** you prefer working practically, want to start earning sooner, or like specific trades.

3. EUD/EUX – combine vocational + academic

The **EUX** program is a **hybrid** where you both learn a trade and get a **studentereksamen** (so you can go to university too). It's a bit harder but gives you more flexibility later.

● **Recommended if** you like both school and practical work, and want options open.

Other ideas

- **Efterskole:** A year at an *efterskole* (boarding-like school) where you can explore interests (sports, music, media, languages) and grow personally.
- **Study Abroad:** A short program in Latvia, or elsewhere, might deepen your identity and language skills.
- **Gap year or work:** Sometimes a break to work or travel helps clarify your goals.

How to choose?

Here are some questions to ask yourself:

- Do I enjoy studying academic subjects, or do I prefer hands-on learning?
- Do I want to go to university in the future?
- What subjects or activities do I really enjoy?
- Do I want to work and earn money sooner, or study longer?

Next steps

1. **Talk to your UU-vejleder (Youth Guidance Counselor)** – every kommune has them.
2. **Visit educational institutions** – they often have open house events.
3. **Try internships (praktik)** – even a few days can help you decide.
4. **Talk to older students** – they often give honest advice.

If you tell me more about your interests — like subjects you enjoy, hobbies, or future job ideas — I can give more specific advice. Would you like to do that?